

QUBT Case Study — Insider Sell Timeline & Narrative Analysis

1. Company Snapshot

Ticker: QUBT | **Exchange:** NASDAQ | **Sector:** Quantum Optics / Integrated Photonics
Current Price: ~\$10.51 (May 2026) | **52W High:** \$25.84 (Oct 2025) | **52W Low:** \$6.18 (Mar 2026)
Market Cap: ~\$2.5B | **Employees:** 77
Current Narrative: Room-temperature photonic quantum computing, thin-film lithium niobate chips, AI edge inference

2. Narrative Timeline — Five Identities in 25 Years

This is a company that has been five different things.

2001 — Ticketcart, Inc. Selling ink-jet cartridges online for HP, Canon, Epson, and Lexmark.

2007 — Innovative Beverage Group Holdings, Inc. Acquired a beverage company. Pivoted to wholesale distribution of non-alcoholic drinks, energy drinks, and snacks.

2013 — Ceased Operations. Ran out of money. Incurred significant losses.

2017 — Sued and Sold. A shareholder sued for fraud and breach of fiduciary duties. Lost the suit. Went into receivership. Robert Liscouski's Convergent Risk Group bought the shell for \$155,000.

2018 — Quantum Computing Inc. Redomiciled to Delaware. 200:1 reverse stock split. Changed name to Quantum Computing Inc. Changed ticker to QUBT. Announced “shift in business focus to quantum technology.” No quantum technology existed in the company at this point.

2021 — Board Buildout. Robert Fagenson — former NYSE Floor Governor, NYSE Board Vice Chairman, 50+ years on Wall Street — appointed to board and Audit Committee chair. His appointment was explicitly described as advancing Nasdaq listing requirements.

2022 — QPhoton Acquisition. Acquired QPhoton Inc., a quantum photonics startup

founded by Dr. Yuping Huang. Huang became Chief Quantum Officer and board member. This was the company's first contact with actual quantum technology.

2024 — Audit Crisis. BF Borgers (auditor) found guilty of misconduct. QUBT replaced auditor with BPM LLP. Material adjustments to 2022-2023 financials. Going concern warnings since 2023.

2025 Dec — Luminar Semiconductor. Signed \$110M all-cash agreement to acquire Luminar Semiconductor Inc. (subsidiary of bankrupt Luminar Technologies). Photonic components, patents, engineering team.

2026 Q1 — Acquisitions Closed. Luminar Semi and NuCrypt LLC (quantum communications) both completed. Revenue jumped 9,364% in Q1 2026 (from near zero, driven by acquired revenue).

3. Insider Map

Yuping Huang — CEO / Chief Quantum Officer / 10%+ Owner

QPhoton founder. Joined via 2022 merger. The only person in QUBT's history with actual quantum technology credentials. Largest individual insider seller: 1.7M shares sold for \$21.9M total between March-September 2025.

Robert B. Fagenson — Director / Vice Chairman / Audit Committee Chair

This is the Wall Street operator. NYSE Floor Governor. NYSE Board of Directors (elected 1993), eventually Vice Chairman. Managing partner of Fagenson & Co., one of the largest specialist firms on the NYSE trading floor, for 37 years (1970-2007). Vice Chairman of National Holdings Corp. Chairman, President and CEO of Fagenson & Co. (institutional brokerage, investment banking, money management).

Appointed to QUBT board February 2021, explicitly to help the company meet Nasdaq listing requirements. **Sold 100% of his holdings — 100,000 shares at \$15.56 — on September 9, 2025. Walked away completely.**

Christopher Boehmler — Former CFO

Sold 318,885 shares for \$5.5M in June 2025 (85%+ of holdings). Exited at \$16.85-\$20.00 price range.

Michael Turmelle — Director

Sold 200,986 shares for \$2.8M on June 9, 2025. **100% ownership reduction.** Gone.

Javad Shabani — Director

Sold across two tranches: May 2025 (\$11.66) and September 2025 (\$15.28). **100% ownership reduction.** Gone.

Pouya Dianat — Chief Revenue Officer

Sold 17,175 shares on August 25, 2025 at \$15.53. **100% ownership reduction.** Gone.

4. Form 4 Behavior — The Selling Timeline

Date	Insider	Role	Price	Shares	Value	Ownership After
2025-03-25	Huang Yuping	CQO, 10%	\$8.48	-200,000	-\$1.70M	24,051,256
2025-05-19	Huang Yuping	CQO, 10%	\$11.70	-500,000	-\$5.85M	21,236,906
2025-05-19	Shabani Javad	Director	\$11.66	-39,973	-\$466K	0 (sold 100%)
2025-06-09	Boehmler Christopher	CFO	\$16.85	-272,445	-\$4.59M	47,565
2025-06-09	Turmelle Michael	Director	\$14.18	-200,986	-\$2.85M	0 (sold 100%)
2025-06-12	Boehmler Christopher	CFO	\$20.00	-46,440	-\$929K	351,152
2025-08-25	Dianat Pouya	CRO	\$15.53	-17,175	-\$267K	0 (sold 100%)
2025-09-04	Huang Yuping	CEO, 10%	\$14.42	-1,000,000	- \$14.42M	21,287,718
2025-09-05	Shabani Javad	Director	\$15.28	-37,474	-\$573K	0 (sold 100%)
2025-09-09	Fagenson Robert	Director	\$15.56	-100,000	-\$1.56M	0 (sold 100%)

2026-01-07	Begliarbekov Milan	COO	\$11.85	-2,860	-\$34K	24,240
2026-03-10	Roberts Christopher	CFO, GC	\$7.85	-78,262	-\$615K	1,123,038

Total insider selling: ~\$33.8M across 12 transactions.

The September Cluster

Between September 4-9, 2025 — a 5-day window — three insiders sold simultaneously:

- **CEO Huang** sold 1M shares (\$14.42M)
- **Director Shabani** sold his remaining 37K shares (\$573K) — zeroed out
- **Director Fagenson** sold all 100K shares (\$1.56M) — zeroed out

Total cluster: **\$16.5M in 5 days**. Three insiders. Two of them walked away with zero remaining ownership.

The stock was at ~\$15 during the cluster. It ran to \$25.84 three weeks later (Oct 3, 2025). Then it collapsed. By March 2026 it hit \$6.18.

5. Event Alignment

The timing between insider selling and corporate events tells the story.

Pre-selling phase (Q1 2025): Huang starts selling at \$8.48 in March. The company has no major announcements. He's selling into a flat market.

Acceleration phase (May-June 2025): Huang accelerates to 500K shares. Shabani and Turmelle sell out entirely. CFO Boehmler dumps 85% of holdings across two transactions at \$16.85-\$20.00. The stock is climbing. No one inside is buying.

The cluster (September 2025): CEO Huang sells 1M shares in a single transaction — his largest. Fagenson (the NYSE veteran) sells 100% of his holdings. Shabani sells his remaining scraps. This is the heaviest insider selling window in the company's history.

Peak and collapse (Oct 2025 - Mar 2026): Stock peaks at \$25.84 on October 3 — three weeks after the cluster sell. Then declines steadily.

Luminar Semi announcement (Dec 2025): \$110M acquisition announced. This is the next narrative shift — from pure quantum to photonics + semiconductor + manufacturing. The company now has a new story to tell. But insiders already sold.

Post-acquisition selling (Q1 2026): New CFO Roberts sells at \$7.85. COO Milan sells token amount at \$11.85. These are cleanup trades, not the main event.

6. Exit Reference Zone

Based on the core insider selling activity (excluding the earliest \$8.48 trade and the latest \$7.85 cleanup trade):

Core insider exit range: \$11.66 – \$15.56

This is where the majority of insider value was extracted. Six of the twelve transactions occurred at prices between \$11.66 and \$15.56.

The CFO's \$20.00 sale is an outlier on the high end. The March 2025 and March 2026 sales are outliers on the low end.

As of May 2026, QUBT trades at ~\$10.51 — below the core insider exit zone.

7. Narrative Hypothesis

QUBT's pattern across its 25-year history is consistent: acquire a new identity, rename, re-story, attract capital, repeat.

The current chapter — photonic quantum computing + semiconductor acquisition — follows the same structural logic as every previous pivot. The company acquired its way into the quantum space (QPhoton, 2022), then acquired its way deeper (Luminar Semi, NuCrypt, 2026). Each acquisition brings real technology, real patents, and a new vocabulary of buzzwords (photonics, lithium niobate, edge inference, quantum communications).

The Luminar Semi acquisition is structurally interesting: buying a subsidiary out of bankruptcy for \$110M in cash means QUBT got real manufacturing infrastructure at a discount. This is not nothing. But the question is whether the narrative ("quantum + photonics + semiconductor + AI edge") is a business strategy or a capital markets strategy.

The insider behavior suggests the latter. When the CEO sells \$21.9M worth of stock, the CFO dumps 85% of his holdings, and the NYSE veteran on the board zeroes out his entire position — all before the stock peaks — the capital markets signal is clear.

8. Research Conclusion

Designation: Narrative Vehicle with Real Technology Acquisitions

QUBT is not a fraud. It has real technology (QPhoton's photonic systems, Luminar's semiconductor components, NuCrypt's quantum communications). It has real revenue now (\$3.7M in Q1 2026). It has \$1.4B in cash.

But the insider behavior pattern — sustained, heavy selling across multiple insiders, with several board members and officers exiting to zero ownership, all occurring before the stock's 52-week high — indicates that the people closest to the company valued their stock significantly below where the market eventually priced it.

The core insider exit zone (\$11.66-\$15.56) is the reference frame. If QUBT trades significantly above this zone without fundamental changes that insiders are willing to hold through, the risk of another drawdown is elevated.

Watch for: Whether any insider starts buying at current levels. That would be a meaningful signal reversal. So far, zero insider purchases in the dataset.

Data sources: SEC EDGAR Form 4, 8-K, DEF 14A filings. Price data approximate. This is research and analysis for educational purposes only. Not financial advice.